

PEDAL ON THE FUTURE

THE MG WINDSOR EV, WITH ITS FUTURISTIC AND MINIMALIST DESIGN, COMBINES THE BEST OF BOTH WORLDS—COMFORT AND TECHNOLOGY

BY CHETAN BHUTANI

IF THERE'S ONE way to describe the newly-launched MG Windsor EV, it's that the spacious and tech-forward vehicle is suited for city traffic. In a market flooded with SUVs, the Windsor EV blends elements of a hatchback, Multi-Purpose Vehicle, and a compact SUV.

Ample storage options and a well-designed centre console featuring multiple charging ports, cup holders, and wireless smartphone charging makes the car suitable for both daily commuting and for longer trips. The cascading split lighting set-up, with pod-style LED headlights and connected LED daytime running lights (DRLs), enhances the front's futuristic appeal.

The Windsor features flush door handles and 18-inch alloy wheels, contributing to its aerodynamic profile. At the rear, it continues its novel look with a

roof spoiler and striking connected LED tail lamps. Available in four colours—Starburst Black, Pearl White, Clay Beige, and Turquoise Green—the Windsor offers something for everyone.

Inside the cabin, spaciousness and minimalist design are impressive. A massive 15.6-inch touchscreen controls almost all functions. While this tech-forward interface enhances the futuristic vibe, it may require some adjustments for users accustomed to physical buttons. Quilted seats provide a high level of comfort, with plenty of legroom and headroom, particularly in the rear. The flat floor, thanks to the skateboard platform, ensures comfort for even the middle passenger.

The vehicle offers four drive modes—Eco, Eco+, Normal, and Sport. In my experience, the Sport mode feels more responsive, delivering a zippy performance. The Eco and Eco+ modes, meanwhile, are designed to prioritise range over power.

Prices start at ₹13.50 lakh for the base Excite variant, ₹14.50 lakh for the mid-range Exclusive, and ₹15.50 lakh for the Essence, which I drove. MG's innovative Battery-as-a-Service (BaaS) model, where customers pay ₹9.99 lakh for the car and ₹3.5 per km for battery usage, makes the Windsor more accessible.

Down the road, the Windsor EV stands out for its bold design, tech-forward interior, and practical features. While it may not set performance benchmarks, it excels in providing a stress-free driving experience, thus making it a strong contender in India's dynamic EV market. **BT**

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